

6.5 Primary and Secondary Data

بنیادی ڈیٹا (Primary Data) محقق خود کسی خاص مقصد کے لیے براہ راست جمع کرتا ہے، مثلاً سروے، انٹرویو یا مشاہدہ۔

CS XI

Chapter 6: Digital Literacy

Lecture 06 of 14

★ Golden

6.5 Primary and Secondary Data ★ Golden

LEARN IT

Whenever you use data, it is important to know **where it came from**. The source affects how much **control** the researcher had over collecting it, and how **confidently** the results can be used.

6.5.1 Primary Data

Primary data is collected **first-hand** by the researcher for a **particular purpose**. It is gathered **directly** from people, events or situations, rather than taken from an already published source.

Sources: interviews, surveys, observations, experiments.

6.5.2 Secondary Data

Secondary data has **already been collected by someone else** and is being used again for a **new purpose**. It is taken from existing archives (stored collections of information).

Sources: books, research articles, official reports, web statistics, online databases.

Primary Data

Fresh, direct collection
(You do the work)

Surveys · Interviews · Observation

Secondary Data

Existing archives
(Someone else did it)

Books · Reports · Databases

Primary data is collected by you; secondary data was collected by others.

6.5.3 Difference Between Primary and Secondary Data

Aspect	Primary Data	Secondary Data
Source	Collected directly by the researcher.	Already collected by others.

Examples	Survey responses, interviews, observations.	Reports, articles, websites, databases.
Purpose	Prepared for a specific study.	Reused for a new purpose.
Control	High control over questions and collection process.	Limited control because the data already exists.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Primary or secondary? Hira is researching "Internet use among students in Hyderabad".

(a) She sends a Google Form to 50 students in her college. → **Primary** (she collected it herself, for this study).

(b) She uses a PTA (Pakistan Telecommunication Authority) report on the number of broadband users in Pakistan. → **Secondary** (PTA collected it for its own purpose; Hira reuses it).

(c) She counts how many students use phones in the library during one hour. → **Primary** (her own observation).

(d) She quotes a statistic from a research article. → **Secondary**.

Why use both? Her primary data tells her about *her own* college; the secondary data lets her **compare** it with the national picture.

REMEMBER IT

Primary = "1st hand" (you collect it first). Secondary = "2nd hand" (like a second-hand book – someone else used it first).

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: Thinking data from a website is always primary because "I found it myself". **Fix:** What matters is *who collected* the data. If someone else collected it and you only found it, it is secondary.

اردو میں سمجھیں

بنیادی ڈیٹا (Primary Data) محقق خود کسی خاص مقصد کے لیے براہ راست جمع کرتا ہے، مثلاً سروے، انٹرویو یا مشاہدہ۔ ثانوی ڈیٹا (Secondary Data) پہلے ہی کسی اور نے جمع کیا ہوتا ہے اور اسے نئے مقصد کے لیے دوبارہ استعمال کیا جاتا ہے، جیسے کتابیں، رپورٹس اور آن لائن ڈیٹا بیس۔ بنیادی ڈیٹا پر محقق کا کنٹرول زیادہ اور ثانوی ڈیٹا پر کم ہوتا ہے۔

EXAM TIP

"Differentiate between primary and secondary data" is one of the most-asked questions in this chapter. Draw the four-row table: **Source, Examples, Purpose, Control**. Learn it exactly. Add one example from each side to secure full marks.

CHECK YOURSELF

1. Which type of data gives the researcher high control?
2. Is a government census report primary or secondary data for your project?
3. Give two sources of primary data.

Answers: 1. Primary data. 2. Secondary (someone else collected it). 3. Any two: interviews, surveys, observations, experiments.

Extra board practice

These MCQs and questions are extra to the textbook. Close the notes, attempt them, then open the key.

MCQ 1. Primary data is:

- a. Collected by you for this question
- b. Copied from a textbook table always
- c. Always tertiary
- d. A NAND output

MCQ 2. Secondary data is:

- a. Collected by others, reused
- b. Your interview today
- c. Always fake
- d. A pie only

MCQ 3. You control quality more with:

- a. Primary
- b. Secondary always
- c. Tertiary always
- d. None

MCQ 4. Secondary is often:

- a. Faster and cheaper
- b. Always more accurate
- c. Always ethical-free
- d. Always qualitative

MCQ 5. Census tables you download are:

- a. Secondary for you
- b. Primary for you
- c. Not data
- d. A query object

MCQ 6. A common exam pair is:

- a. Define both + one difference + one example each
- b. Only Big O
- c. Only ER
- d. Only Agile

Extra short questions

1. Table: primary vs secondary on source, control, cost, example.
2. One risk of secondary.
3. One risk of primary.
4. Can a project use both?

Extra long question

1. For "canteen waiting time", list primary and secondary data you would gather, and how each could lie. ★ Golden.

Extra answer key

MCQs: 1. A 2. A 3. A 4. A 5. A 6. A

Short

1. You vs others; high vs low control; high vs low cost; survey vs PBS stats.
2. Out of date, different definitions, hidden bias.
3. Small sample, poor questions, time.
4. Yes — and the book's inquiry project does.

Long

1. Primary: observe queues, survey. Secondary: last year's complaint log, news on food inflation. Lies: observed only at 8am; old log incomplete. Triangulate.

Next lecture: 6.6 Designing a Data-Collection Approach